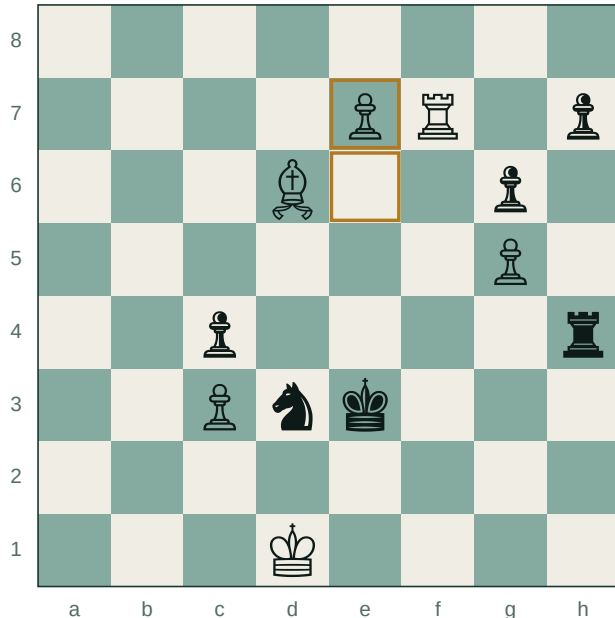


Hook mating nets: Black, move 52

Hook mating nets

Black to move



Previous move: 52.e7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52...Rh1+ 53. Rf1 Rxf1+ 54. Kc2 Rc1#

52...Rh1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **53.Rf1**.

53...Rxf1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on f1. Recorded reply: **54.Kc2**.

54...Rc1# Mate: rook on c1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on c1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A hook-type mating net combines rook pressure with knight control and supporting pawn geometry. The supporting pieces can matter more than the apparent value of a sacrifice.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the final checking line and then trace which friendly pieces protect the attacker and control the king's exits.

The defending king is on d1. Geometrically undefended: rook on f7 and bishop on d6. Check for tactical protection.